

History & Civics Playbook

Early Man to the Guptas · Local Self-Government (Rural & Urban)

ICSE Class 6 · Full Book · Final Exam Ready

Play & Learn Notes · Independent study material, not affiliated with CISCE.
Chapter names and order can differ slightly between schools and publishers. Follow your school's exam syllabus.

How to use this playbook

Part	Chapters
History	1. Introduction to History · 2. Early Man · 3. Indus Valley Civilisation · 4. Mesopotamian, Egyptian and Chinese Civilisations · 5. The Vedic Civilisation · 6. Jainism and Buddhism · 7. The Mauryan Empire · 8. The Sangam Age · 9. The Age of the Guptas
Civics	10. Rural Local Self-Government · 11. Urban Local Self-Government

Different schools may use slightly different chapter numbers. Teach by topic.

> ⭐ **Exam Tip: How to score full marks in History & Civics**
>
> 1. Make a **timeline** for every chapter. Dates and the correct order earn easy marks.
> 2. Learn the "**3 Ps**": **People** (kings, preachers), **Places** (sites, capitals), **Points** (features, teachings).
> 3. For long answers, write **points with headings**, not one long paragraph.
> 4. Civics: learn the **structure** (who is elected, for how long, and their functions) as a table.

BC/BCE and AD/CE

- **BC (BCE)** means before the birth of Christ. Count **backwards**: 500 BC is **older** than 200 BC.
- **AD (CE)** means after the birth of Christ. Count **forwards**.
- **Century:** 100 years. The 3rd century BC = 300–201 BC.

1. Introduction to History

- **History** is the study of the **past**, based on **evidence** or **sources**.
- **Pre-history:** the time before writing was invented. **Proto-history:** writing existed but can't be read yet (the Harappan script). **History:** the period with written records we can read.

Sources of history

Archaeological sources	Literary sources
Inscriptions (writing on rocks, pillars, copper plates)	**Religious texts**: the Vedas, Jataka tales, Jain Agamas
Coins (tell us about kings, dates and trade)	**Secular texts**: Kautilya's *Arthashastra*, Kalidasa's plays
Monuments (temples, stupas, forts)	**Foreign accounts**: Megasthenes (*Indica*), Fa-Hien, Hiuen Tsang
Artefacts (pots, tools, jewellery, seals)	

- **Archaeologists** dig up and study remains. **Historians** study sources to write history.
- **Carbon dating** helps to find out the age of old objects.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Sources = "MICA": **M**onuments, **I**nscriptions, **C**oins, **A**rtefacts (archaeological) + books (literary).

📍 **Mumbai Connection**

Kanheri Caves in Sanjay Gandhi National Park, Borivali, are more than 2,000 years old. Their **inscriptions** are a real historical source right inside Mumbai!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. What is history?
2. Name two archaeological and two literary sources.
3. Which is older: 300 BC or 100 BC?
4. Who wrote *Indica*?

2. Early Man

- Early humans were **hunter-gatherers**. They moved from place to place (**nomadic**) in search of food.

Age	Features
Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)	Rough stone tools, hunting and gathering, lived in caves, **discovered fire**
Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age)	Small, sharp tools (**microliths**), began to **tame animals** (the dog was the first)
Neolithic (New Stone Age)	**Polished** stone tools, **farming** began, **settled life** in villages, the **wheel** was invented, pottery and weaving
Chalcolithic (Copper-Stone Age)	Copper tools used alongside stone ones

- **Bhimbetka** (Madhya Pradesh): rock shelters with cave paintings
- **Mehrgarh** (now in Pakistan): one of the earliest farming villages

Important discoveries

1. **Fire:** warmth, cooking, protection from animals, light
2. **Wheel:** transport (carts) and pottery (the potter's wheel)
3. **Farming:** a settled life, villages, surplus food

🧠 **Memory Trick**
"Paleo → Meso → Neo" = "Old → Middle → New" (like Junior, Middle and Senior school!)
Neolithic = Never moving again (they settled down and farmed).

🎲 **Play It in Class: Stone Age Charades**
Students act out early humans: hunting, making fire, painting cave walls, taming a dog, farming, using a wheel. The class guesses the activity **and** the age!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Why were early humans nomadic?
2. What is a microlith?
3. Name two great discoveries of the Neolithic Age.
4. Where are the Bhimbetka rock shelters?

3. The Indus Valley (Harappan) Civilisation

- **Period:** about **2500 BC to 1750 BC**. It developed along the **Indus river** and its tributaries.
- **Discovered** in **1921** by **Daya Ram Sahni** (Harappa). **R.D. Banerji** discovered **Mohenjo-daro** in **1922**. **Sir John Marshall** led the excavations.
- **Important sites:** Harappa and Mohenjo-daro (Pakistan); **Lothal** and **Dholavira** (Gujarat); **Kalibangan** (Rajasthan); **Rakhigarhi** and Banawali (Haryana); Ropar (Punjab)

Town planning (the most remarkable feature)

- Cities were planned on a **grid pattern**: streets met at **right angles**.
- They were divided into a **citadel** (a raised upper town for important buildings) and a **lower town** (where people lived).
- **Covered drains** ran along the streets. It was one of the **best drainage systems** of the ancient world.
- Houses were made of **burnt bricks** of standard sizes, with wells and bathrooms.
- **The Great Bath** at Mohenjo-daro was waterproofed with bitumen.
- **The Granary** stored grain, and the **dockyard at Lothal** shows sea trade.

Life of the people

- **Occupations:** farming (wheat, barley, cotton, the first people to grow cotton), trade (with Mesopotamia), crafts (beads, pottery, seals)
- **Seals:** made of **steatite**, with animals such as the **unicorn**, bull and elephant, and a script that **has not yet been read**
- **Religion:** worship of the **Mother Goddess**, a "**Pashupati**" seal (a proto-Shiva figure), trees (peepal) and animals
- **Art:** the **Dancing Girl** (bronze) and the **Priest King** (stone statue)

Decline (possible reasons)

Floods, earthquakes, changes in the river's course, drying of the Saraswati river, invasion, epidemics

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
> **Harappan sites: "Hari Mohan Lost Doll Kali Rakhi"**: Harappa, Mohenjo-daro, Lothal, Dholavira, Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi. **The Harappans were "Grid Gurus"**: grid streets, great drains, the Great Bath, granary.

> 📍 **Mumbai Connection**
> Mumbai still struggles with drainage every monsoon. But the Harappans had **covered drains 4,500 years ago**! Ask students: "What can Mumbai learn from Mohenjo-daro?"

🎲 Play It in Class: Plan a Harappan City

On chart paper, teams design a city with a citadel, a lower town, grid roads, covered drains, a Great Bath and a granary. Each team explains its plan like a city architect.

✏️ Quick Check

1. When and by whom was Harappa discovered?
2. Describe three features of Harappan town planning.
3. What were Harappan seals made of? Name one animal on them.
4. Name the dockyard site of the Harappan civilisation.

4. Mesopotamian, Egyptian and Chinese Civilisations

	Mesopotamian	Egyptian	Chinese
River	**Tigris and Euphrates** ("land between two rivers")	**Nile** ("Egypt is the gift of the Nile")	**Hwang Ho (Yellow River)**
Present country	Iraq	Egypt	China
Writing	**Cuneiform** (wedge-shaped, on clay tablets)	**Hieroglyphics** (picture writing, on **papyrus**)	Pictographic script (ideograms)
Famous for	**Ziggurats** (temple towers), the **wheel**, the 60-minute hour and 360° circle, the **Code of Hammurabi** (laws)	**Pyramids** (tombs of the **Pharaohs**), **mummies**, a 365-day calendar, the Sphinx	**Silk**, paper, the compass, the **Great Wall**, oracle bones
Rulers	City-state kings (Sumerians, Babylonians)	**Pharaohs** (god-kings)	Dynasties (Shang)

- Hammurabi's law code included the idea of "**an eye for an eye**".
- The **Great Pyramid of Giza** was built for Pharaoh **Khufu**.
- The **Hwang Ho** is called "**China's Sorrow**" because of its floods.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Rivers: "TE-N-H": Tigris and Euphrates = Mesopotamia, Nile = Egypt, Hwang Ho = China.
Writing: "Clay-Cuneiform, Papyrus-Pictures (hieroglyphics)"

🎲 **Play It in Class: Write Like the Ancients**

Students write their name in "cuneiform" (by pressing the tip of a pencil into clay or soft dough) and in "hieroglyphics" (drawing a picture for each sound). Display them like a museum!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Which rivers is Mesopotamia located between?
2. Why is Egypt called "the gift of the Nile"?
3. What is a ziggurat?
4. Why is the Hwang Ho called "China's Sorrow"?

5. The Vedic Civilisation

- The **Aryans** came to the **Sapta Sindhu** region (the land of seven rivers, in the north-west of India) around **1500 BC**.
- **Early Vedic Period** (about 1500–1000 BC) and **Later Vedic Period** (about 1000–600 BC)

Vedic literature

- **Four Vedas: Rig Veda** (the oldest: hymns), **Sama Veda** (music and songs), **Yajur Veda** (rituals and sacrifices), **Atharva Veda** (medicine, magic and daily life)
- **Upanishads** (philosophy), **Brahmanas**, **Aranyakas**, and the epics, the **Ramayana** (by Valmiki) and the **Mahabharata** (by Ved Vyasa)

Life in the Vedic Age

	Early Vedic	Later Vedic
Society	The **family** was the basic unit, women had **respect** (Gargi, Maitreyi, Apala), no strict caste	**The Varna system became rigid**: Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, Shudras. Women's status fell.
Polity	Tribal: a **Rajan** (chief) with the **Sabha** (council of elders) and the **Samiti** (assembly of the people)	Bigger kingdoms (**Janapadas**), the king became powerful, big sacrifices (**Ashvamedha**, Rajasuya)
Economy	Cattle-rearing (cows were wealth)	**Farming** with iron ploughs
Religion	Nature gods: **Indra** (rain), **Agni** (fire), **Varuna** (water), **Surya**	Prajapati, Vishnu, Rudra; rituals became complex

- **The four ashramas (stages of life):** Brahmacharya (student), Grihastha (householder), Vanaprastha (retired), Sanyasa (renunciation)
- **Education:** in **gurukuls**, where students lived with the teacher

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Vedas: "Rita Sang Yummy Atchaar": Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva. **Ashramas: "Students Get Very Sleepy"**: Brahmacharya (student), Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa.

🎲 **Play It in Class: Sabha vs Samiti Role-Play**

Split the class into a Sabha (elders) and a Samiti (people's assembly). They debate a village problem ("Should we move to a new grazing land?"). The Rajan (a student) decides. This shows early democracy!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. Name the four Vedas. Which is the oldest?
2. What were the Sabha and the Samiti?
3. Name two learned women of the Vedic Age.
4. Write the four ashramas in order.

6. Jainism and Buddhism

- In the **6th century BC**, people questioned costly rituals and the rigid caste system. Two great teachers showed a simple path.

	Jainism	Buddhism
Founder or great teacher	**Vardhamana Mahavira**, the **24th Tirthankara** (the 1st was Rishabhanatha)	**Gautama Buddha** (Siddhartha)
Born	**Kundagrama** near Vaishali (Bihar), 540 BC	**Lumbini** (Nepal), 563 BC
Enlightenment	**Kaivalya** at the age of 42, becoming a **Jina** (conqueror)	Under the **Bodhi tree** at **Bodh Gaya**
First sermon		**Sarnath**, near Varanasi
Died	**Pavapuri** (Bihar)	**Kushinagar** (U.P.), called the **Mahaparinirvana**
Main teachings	**Three Jewels (Triratna):** right faith, right knowledge, right conduct. **Five vows: ahimsa** (non-violence), truth, non-stealing, non-possession, chastity	**Four Noble Truths**, the **Eightfold Path**, the **Middle Path** (no extreme luxury and no extreme suffering)
Sects	**Digambaras** (sky-clad) and **Svetambaras** (white-clad)	**Hinayana** and **Mahayana**
Holy books	**Agamas**	**Tripitakas** (written in **Pali**)

The Four Noble Truths (Buddha)

1. Life is full of **suffering**.
2. **Desire** is the cause of suffering.
3. Suffering ends when desire ends.
4. Follow the **Eightfold Path** to end desire.

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
> **Buddha's 4 holy places: "Lumbini–Bodh Gaya–Sarnath–Kushinagar" = "Born–Became Buddha–Spoke–Said goodbye". Jainism = "Jeeva-daya"**: be kind to every living being (ahimsa).

> 📍 **Mumbai Connection**
> Mumbai has Buddhist history! The **Kanheri Caves** (Borivali) were a big Buddhist monastery with more than 100 caves. The **Global Vipassana Pagoda** at Gorai is a modern monument to the Buddha's teachings, which students can visit.

🎲 Play It in Class: Path Game

Draw the Eightfold Path as 8 squares on the floor. A student steps on each square and gives a real-life example ("Right speech: I won't lie to my friend"). The class claps for good examples.

✏️ Quick Check

1. Who was the 24th Tirthankara?
2. Where did the Buddha get enlightenment and give his first sermon?
3. Name the Three Jewels of Jainism.
4. Write the Four Noble Truths.

7. The Mauryan Empire

- **Founder: Chandragupta Maurya** (321 BC), with the help of **Chanakya (Kautilya)**, who wrote the **Arthashastra** (a book on government).
- **Capital: Pataliputra** (now Patna).
- **Megasthenes**, a Greek ambassador sent by Seleucus, lived in Chandragupta's court and wrote **Indica**.
- **Bindusara:** Chandragupta's son.

Ashoka the Great (273–232 BC)

- He fought the **Kalinga War** (about **261 BC**, in present-day Odisha). He was very sad at the bloodshed (about 1 lakh killed), gave up war and followed **Buddhism**.
- **Dhamma (Dharma):** his code of moral conduct: non-violence, respect for elders, kindness to animals and servants, tolerance of all religions.
- He spread his message through **rock edicts and pillar edicts** in **Prakrit** (in the **Brahmi** script).
- He sent missionaries, including his son **Mahendra** and daughter **Sanghamitra**, to **Sri Lanka**.
- **The Lion Capital of the Sarnath pillar** is now **India's National Emblem**, and the **Ashoka Chakra** is on our **national flag**.

Mauryan administration

- The **king** was supreme, helped by a council of ministers (**Mantri Parishad**).
- The empire was divided into **provinces**, each under a prince. Spies kept the king informed.
- **Pataliputra** was run by a **committee of 30 members** (6 boards of 5 each).

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Mauryan dynasty: "Chandra Bindu Ashok" (C-B-A): Chandragupta → Bindusara → Ashoka.
Ashoka's change: "War → Wow → Peace" (Kalinga war → shock and regret → Dhamma).

📍 **Mumbai Connection**

Fragments of an **Ashokan rock edict** were found at **Sopara (Nala Sopara)**, just north of Mumbai! In ancient times Sopara (Shurparaka) was a busy **port**. Ashoka's message reached our own city's doorstep!

🎲 **Play It in Class: Ashoka's Edict Writing**

Each student writes their own "edict" (a rule for a kind and peaceful classroom) on a "stone" made of grey chart paper. Display them as the "Class Edict Pillar". Discuss: how are these like Ashoka's Dhamma?

✏️ Quick Check

1. Who founded the Mauryan Empire? Who helped him?
2. What was the result of the Kalinga War?
3. What is Dhamma?
4. Which Mauryan monument is now our National Emblem?

8. The Sangam Age

- **Sangam** means an **assembly** of Tamil **poets and scholars**, held at **Madurai** under the patronage of the **Pandya** kings.
- **Period:** about **300 BC to AD 300**, in the far south of India (**Tamilakam**).
- **Three Sangams** were held. The literature of the third Sangam survives.

The three kingdoms

Kingdom	Capital	Emblem	Famous ruler
Cheras	Vanji (Kerala)	**Bow**	Senguttuvan
Cholas	Uraiyur (and the port of **Puhar/Kaveripattinam**)	**Tiger**	**Karikala** (built the **Grand Anicut (Kallanai)** dam on the Kaveri)
Pandyas	**Madurai**	**Fish**	Nedunjeliyan

Sangam literature and life

- **Tolkappiyam:** a book of Tamil grammar
- **Silappadikaram** (story of an anklet) and **Manimekalai**: the two great epics
- **Tirukkural** by **Thiruvalluvar**: wise sayings
- **Trade:** busy sea trade with the **Romans** in pepper, pearls, ivory, spices and muslin. Roman coins have been found in the south. The ports included **Muziris**, Puhar and Korkai.

🧠 **Memory Trick**

Emblems: "Chera's Bow, Chola's Tiger, Pandya's Fish": "Bow-Tiger-Fish" (B-T-F). Sangam = "Sammelan" of poets.

🎲 **Play It in Class: Kingdom Flags**

Three teams are the Cheras, Cholas and Pandyas. Each makes a flag with its emblem and presents its capital, ruler and one achievement. Then hold a "Sangam" where each team recites a 2-line poem!

✏️ **Quick Check**

1. What does "Sangam" mean? Where was it held?
2. Name the emblems of the Cheras, Cholas and Pandyas.
3. Who wrote the Tirukkural?
4. Which Chola king built the Grand Anicut?

9. The Age of the Guptas: the Golden Age

- **Founder: Sri Gupta**. **Chandragupta I** (AD 320) started the Gupta era and took the title **Maharajadhiraja**.
- **Samudragupta:** a great conqueror. He is called the "**Napoleon of India**" (by historian V.A. Smith). He was also a poet and **veena** player. The **Allahabad Pillar Inscription**, by his court poet **Harisena**, describes his conquests.
- **Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya):** defeated the **Shakas**. His court had the **Navaratnas** (nine gems), including **Kalidasa**. The Chinese traveller **Fa-Hien** visited India in his reign.

Why is it called the Golden Age?

Field	Achievements
Literature	**Kalidasa**: *Abhijnana Shakuntalam*, *Meghaduta*, *Raghuvamsha*. **Vishnu Sharma**: the *Panchatantra*
Science and maths	**Aryabhata**: the concept of **zero**, the value of **pi (π)**, said that the **Earth rotates on its axis**. **Varahamihira**: astronomy. **Brahmagupta**: mathematics
Medicine	**Sushruta** (surgery), **Charaka** (medicine). (Their works were compiled and studied widely in this period.)
Art and architecture	**Ajanta cave paintings** (some caves), the **Dashavatara temple** at Deogarh, the **Iron Pillar** at Mehrauli, Delhi, which **has not rusted** in 1,600 years!
Education	**Nalanda University** was founded
Coins	Beautiful **gold coins** (dinaras)

🧠 **Memory Trick**

The Gupta kings: "Chandu Samosa Chandu": Chandragupta I → Samudragupta → Chandragupta II. **Golden Age "LSAE"**: **L**iterature, **S**cience, **A**rt, **E**ducation, all shining like gold!

📍 **Mumbai Connection**

The world-famous **Ajanta Caves** (Aurangabad district, Maharashtra) have paintings from different periods, some from the Gupta age. They are a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** in our own state. Plan a class trip!

🎲 **Play It in Class: Navaratna Quiz Show**

Nine students each play a "gem" (Kalidasa, Aryabhata, Varahamihira...). The class asks yes/no questions to guess who is who. The best "gem" performance wins!

✏️ Quick Check

1. Why is Samudragupta called the "Napoleon of India"?
2. Name two works of Kalidasa.
3. What were Aryabhata's contributions?
4. Give two reasons why the Gupta age is called the Golden Age.

10. Civics: Rural Local Self-Government (Panchayati Raj)

- **Local self-government:** local people elect their own representatives to solve **local problems** (water, roads, cleanliness, schools).
- The **73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992)** gave Panchayati Raj **constitutional status**.
- It is a **three-tier system**:

Level	Body	Head
Village	**Gram Panchayat**	**Sarpanch** (with an Up-Sarpanch)
Block	**Panchayat Samiti**	**Chairman (Sabhapati)**
District	**Zilla Parishad**	**Chairman (Adhyaksha)**

Gram Sabha and Gram Panchayat

- **Gram Sabha: all adults (18+)** in the village who are on the voters' list. They elect the Gram Panchayat and check its work.
- **Gram Panchayat:** elected members (**Panchs**) and the **Sarpanch**, for **5 years**.
- **Reservation:** seats are reserved for **SCs, STs** and **women (at least one-third)**. In Maharashtra, **50%** of seats are reserved for women.
- **The Secretary (Gram Sevak)** keeps records.

Functions of the Gram Panchayat

- **Compulsory:** clean drinking water, village roads, drainage and sanitation, street lighting, primary schools, recording births and deaths
- **Optional:** libraries, playgrounds, community halls, planting trees
- **Income:** taxes (on houses, land and markets), fees, and **government grants**

Nyaya Panchayat

- Settles **small disputes** in villages quickly and cheaply.

> 🧠 **Memory Trick**
> **Three tiers: "Gram → Samiti → Zilla" = "Village → Block → District"**, like a family: **child → parent → grandparent**. **Sarpanch = "Sar" (head) + "Panch" (council member).**

> 🎲 **Play It in Class: Mock Gram Sabha**
> The class becomes a village. Hold an election for the Sarpanch and 5 Panchs. Then hold a meeting on a problem ("The village well is dirty"). Members propose solutions and vote. Discuss where the money will come from!

✏️ Quick Check

1. What is local self-government?
2. Name the three tiers of Panchayati Raj.
3. What is a Gram Sabha?
4. Write three functions of a Gram Panchayat.

11. Civics: Urban Local Self-Government

- The **74th Constitutional Amendment (1992)** gave urban bodies **constitutional status**.

Body	For	Head
Municipal Corporation	**Big cities** (Mumbai, Pune, Delhi)	**Mayor** (elected), with the **Municipal Commissioner** (an IAS officer) as the administrative head
Municipal Council (Municipality)	**Smaller towns**	**President (Chairperson)**
Nagar Panchayat	Areas changing from rural to urban	Chairperson

The Municipal Corporation

- The city is divided into **wards**. Each ward elects a **Corporator (Councillor)** for **5 years**.
- The **Mayor** is the first citizen of the city and chairs the meetings. The **Deputy Mayor** helps.
- The **Municipal Commissioner** is appointed by the **state government** and carries out decisions (the executive head).
- **Committees** (such as the Standing Committee) handle finance, health and education.

Functions

Compulsory	Optional
Water supply, drainage and sewage	Parks, gardens, swimming pools
Garbage collection	Libraries, museums
Hospitals, vaccination	Housing for the poor
Primary schools	City transport
Street lights, roads	Markets
Fire brigade	Cultural programmes
Recording births and deaths	

- **Income: property tax**, water tax, advertisement tax, fees (licences, parking), and grants from the state

> 📍 **Mumbai Connection**
> **BMC (Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation)** is one of the **richest municipal corporations in India**. Mumbai is divided into **wards** (A ward, B ward ...). The BMC runs the city's **water supply** (from lakes like Vaitarna and Tansa), **BEST buses** (through the BEST Undertaking), **hospitals like KEM and Sion**, municipal schools, **garbage collection**, and the **fire brigade**. Students can find out which ward their home is in and who their Corporator is!

🧠 Memory Trick

City vs village: Mayor ↔️ Sarpanch, Corporator ↔️ Panch, Municipal Corporation ↔️ Gram Panchayat. **"Mayor = Face (the leader you see). Commissioner = Hands (gets the work done)."**

🎲 Play It in Class: BMC Problem Solvers

Each team picks a real Mumbai problem (potholes, flooding, garbage, traffic). They write a letter to the "Municipal Commissioner" suggesting 3 solutions, and say which department will handle it.

✏️ Quick Check

1. Which body governs a big city? Name its head.
2. What is a ward? Who represents it?
3. Write four compulsory functions of a Municipal Corporation.
4. Name two sources of income of a Municipal Corporation.

Full-Book Revision Test

Section A (1 mark each)

1. Who discovered Mohenjo-daro?
2. Name the writing script of the Egyptians.
3. Which is the oldest Veda?
4. Where did Mahavira die?
5. Who wrote the Arthashastra?
6. Who is the head of a Gram Panchayat?

Section B (2–3 marks each)

7. Describe the drainage system of the Harappans.
8. Write three differences between the Early and Later Vedic periods.
9. State the Four Noble Truths of Buddhism.
10. What was Ashoka's Dhamma?
11. Name the three Sangam kingdoms, with their emblems.
12. Write the three tiers of Panchayati Raj.

Section C (4 marks each)

13. Why is the Gupta period called the Golden Age? Give four points.
14. Compare the Mesopotamian and Egyptian civilisations (river, writing, buildings, rulers).
15. Explain the composition and functions of a Municipal Corporation, with BMC as an example.

Answer Key

Ch 1: (1) The study of the past, based on sources. (2) Archaeological: coins, inscriptions. Literary: the Vedas, the Arthashastra. (3) 300 BC (4) Megasthenes

Ch 2: (1) They moved in search of food (hunting and gathering). (2) A small, sharp stone tool of the Mesolithic Age. (3) Farming and the wheel (also pottery) (4) Madhya Pradesh

Ch 3: (1) 1921, by Daya Ram Sahni (2) Grid streets, covered drains, burnt-brick houses, a citadel and a lower town (any three) (3) Steatite, with the unicorn or bull (4) Lothal

Ch 4: (1) The Tigris and Euphrates (2) The Nile's floods made the land fertile, and Egypt would be desert without it. (3) A stepped temple tower in Mesopotamia. (4) Its frequent, destructive floods.

Ch 5: (1) Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva. The Rig Veda is the oldest. (2) The Sabha was the council of elders and the Samiti was the assembly of the people. (3) Gargi, Maitreyi (Apala) (4) Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa

Ch 6: (1) Vardhamana Mahavira (2) Enlightenment at Bodh Gaya, first sermon at Sarnath (3) Right faith, right knowledge, right conduct (4) Life has suffering; desire causes suffering; suffering ends when desire ends; follow the Eightfold Path.

Ch 7: (1) Chandragupta Maurya, helped by Chanakya (Kautilya) (2) Ashoka gave up war and followed Buddhism and Dhamma. (3) Ashoka's moral code: non-violence, tolerance, respect for elders, kindness to all. (4) The Lion Capital of Sarnath

Ch 8: (1) An assembly of Tamil poets, held at Madurai (2) Cheras: bow, Cholas: tiger, Pandyas: fish (3) Thiruvalluvar (4) Karikala

Ch 9: (1) Because he won many battles and expanded the empire, like Napoleon. (2) *Abhijnana Shakuntalam*, *Meghaduta* (3) The concept of zero, the value of π, and the Earth's rotation on its axis (4) Great literature (Kalidasa), science (Aryabhata), art (Ajanta, the Iron Pillar), Nalanda University

Ch 10: (1) Local people elect representatives to manage local affairs. (2) Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zilla Parishad (3) All adult voters of a village. (4) Drinking water, village roads, sanitation, street lights, primary schools (any three)

Ch 11: (1) The Municipal Corporation. Its head is the Mayor (and the Commissioner is the executive head). (2) A division of a city. It is represented by a Corporator. (3) Water supply, garbage collection, hospitals, street lights, primary schools, the fire brigade (any four) (4) Property tax, water tax, state grants (any two)

Revision test: (1) R.D. Banerji (2) Hieroglyphics (3) The Rig Veda (4) Pavapuri (5) Kautilya (Chanakya) (6) The Sarpanch (7) Covered drains of burnt brick along the streets, connected to the drains of houses, with manholes for cleaning. (8) Society (no caste vs a rigid varna system), the status of women (high vs low), the economy (cattle vs farming), the polity (a tribal chief vs a powerful king) (9) See the Ch 6 answer (10) A moral code of non-violence, tolerance and kindness, spread through edicts (11) Cheras (bow), Cholas (tiger), Pandyas (fish) (12) Gram Panchayat (village), Panchayat Samiti (block), Zilla Parishad (district) (13) Literature (Kalidasa), science (Aryabhata), art (Ajanta, the Iron Pillar), education (Nalanda), gold coins (14)

Mesopotamia: the Tigris and Euphrates, cuneiform, ziggurats, kings. Egypt: the Nile, hieroglyphics, pyramids, Pharaohs. (15) Composition: corporators elected from wards for 5 years, the Mayor, and the Commissioner appointed by the state. Functions: water, sanitation, hospitals, schools, roads, the fire brigade. For example, the BMC runs Mumbai's water supply, KEM hospital and BEST.